



Parks Board September 20

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vOGrxsygPsE
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Muncie Parks and Recreation Board Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: Tuesday, September 20, 2022

Report Prepared By: Expert Civic Analyst

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Brad Marshall called the Muncie Parks and Recreation Board meeting to order on Tuesday, September 20, 2022 [00:00:22](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Chandra Parks, Mark Irvin, Shannon Powers, Brad Marshall (Presiding Officer).
 - **Absent:** James Letton (excused due to illness).

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:24](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the previous meeting were presented, discussed, and **Approved by Voice Vote** [00:01:13](#).

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

A. Superintendent Report (Carl Malone) 00:01:36

- **Winterization & Maintenance:** Begun for Tuahy Pool (restrooms, feed lines, splash pad lubrication) with assistance from Brandon Bond and field tech Rob Barker.
- **Bond Projects:** Renovations have started on seven of the nine parks on the list, including camera installations at three parks.
- **Fall Beautification:** Tree trimming, pruning, and disposal are underway, leading to discussions regarding tree disposal costs with the sanitation department.
- **Westside Skatepark:** Survey data indicates strong community demand for a multipurpose skate park design. Project timeline is projected for 2023 with an estimated budget of ~\$420,000<U+2013>\$480,000 available.
- **Riverview Park:** Renovations are underway following delays caused by permitting; projected completion is set for 2023.

B. Parks Programming & Events Report (George Fuller) 00:07:34

- **Youth Sports:** Fall soccer numbers are strong. Football (flag and tackle) starts this weekend across three facilities (Central, Ball Corp, Southside) with ~120 kids in flag and ~80 in tackle football, partnering with Central head football coach John Frank.
- **Partnerships & Future Planning:** Next year's summer flag football will partner with the NFL, which will provide all uniforms, t-shirts, towels, and socks at no charge for up to 100 kids. Senior citizen programming is planned for the winter at Cabin 3 due to upcoming renovations in Cabin 6.
- **Trunk or Treat:** The 5th annual event is scheduled for October 22nd at Heekin Park.

C. "Calling Men to Pray" Event Request 00:15:10

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone, joined by community speakers Julius Anderson 00:17:01 (1809 Carver Drive) and Denny Manca 00:18:03 (4105 N. Wheeling Ave).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal for an annual community gathering for men focusing on prayer across eight areas (schools, youth, families, churches, violence prevention, mental health, racial reconciliation, homelessness/poverty). Scheduled for October 1, 2022, from 9:00 AM to 12:00 PM at McCulloch Park (near Cabin 6). No vendors will be present, and local law enforcement (Sheriff's Department) will provide backup support.
- **Action & Vote Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote** (Motion by Mark Irvin, Seconded) 00:27:07.

D. Muncie Homecoming Festival Request 00:27:24

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** George Fuller / Carl Malone.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Scheduled for July 26<U+2013>30, 2023, at McCulloch Park (Cabin 6) and downtown. Future Choices serves as the fiscal agent. Expects 3,000+ attendees. Vended booths will require applications and \$25/day per vendor fees. Security will be a partnership between Muncie PD and the Sheriff's Department.
- **Action & Vote Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote** (Motion by Brad Marshall, Seconded) [00:32:52](#).

E. Prairie Creek Reservoir Report (Dustin Clark) [00:33:53](#)

- **Rules Proposal:** A comprehensive, newly compiled draft of Prairie Creek rules has been reviewed by legal counsel (Aubrey Crist) and is presented to the board for review, with a target approval date by the end of 2022 to take effect January 1, 2023. The draft will be shared with Indiana/American Water and key stakeholders.
- **Flotation Docks:** Officially announced the transition to modern, extra-wide flotation piers starting with phase one (1/3 of docks) for the 2023 boating season. Docks will feature security gates.
- **Free Pay Beach Admission:** Starting in 2023, entrance to the Prairie Creek Pay Beach will be entirely free (\$0) to remove financial barriers for citizens, while maintaining lifeguard and attendant oversight.
- **Ruble Triathlon Event Request:** Presented by Zach Ruble (Ruble Triathlon) for a sprint and Olympic distance triathlon on June 10, 2023, expecting ~300 participants.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote** [00:33:53](#) / [01:06:34](#).

F. Old Business: Tree Removal Costs & Wood Waste Disposal [01:37:40](#)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kelly McClelland, Urban Forester.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed unexpected billing from the sanitation department/East Central Recycling for wood waste disposal. Historically disposal was covered, but recent policy shifts have introduced charges. Current arrangement limits dumping to \$1,000/week (\$52,000/year), but major storms or heavy urban forestry work could easily exceed this. The board discussed the need for formal memoranda of understanding (MOUs) and budget line items for 2023.

G. Old Business: Rental Fees & Policies [01:31:12](#)

- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding standardized park equipment and facility rental fee schedules. Board members emphasized the need for clear criteria and a formal vetting/waiver process for "partnerships" to avoid subsidizing for-profit events and ensure equitable treatment across the city. Further research will be conducted on non-reverting fund allocations.
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:52:47 Dustin Clark (representing Granville Neighborhood Association):** Provided positive updates on neighborhood revitalization, noting that the basketball court renovation at Jack's Park is complete (scraping, painting, hoop repairs). Upcoming action items include replacing missing street/park lights, securing a park shelter, and developing a walking path utilizing bond funding and park department support.
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Ongoing coordination for the 2023 budget, upcoming stakeholder reviews for Prairie Creek rules, and security camera installations at high-vandalism parks by the end of the week.
 - **Adjournment: Approved by Voice Vote 01:55:35.**
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